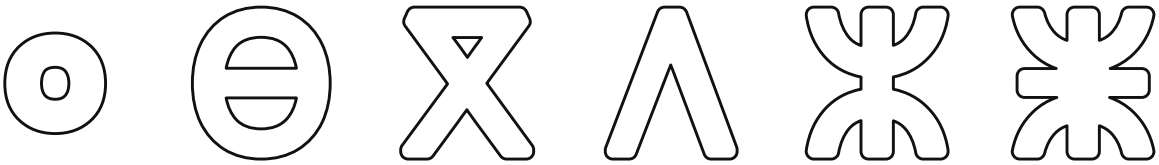
ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 58

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Tamazight Alphabet

ⵕⴰⵎⴰⵣⵉⵖ ⴰⵍⵖⴰⴱⵉⵟ ⵏ ⵜⴰⵎⴰⵡⴰⵙⵜ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 33 Tifinagh Letters with English Phonetics



Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Tamazight Alphabet — ⵓⴰⵣⵓⵍ ⵏ ⵜⵣⵍⵉⵜ

Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 58

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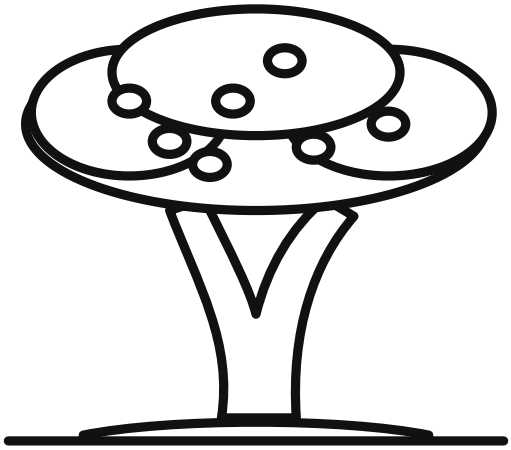
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Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

Fonts: Noto Sans Tifinagh (and an emboldened copy of it for the big letters), Baloo 2, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

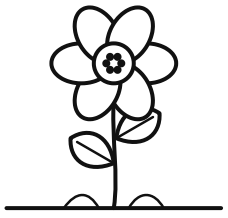


This book belongs to
ⴰⵏⵉⵙ ⴰⵏ ⵉⵏⵓ

I started learning Tamazight on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 58 is Tamazight. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- Every word is shown three ways: in **Tifinagh**, in the official **Latin transcription** (in bold), and in an **easy English sound guide**: ***aman*** · *ah-mahn*.
- **A dot under a letter** (*ḍ ṛ ṣ ṭ ẓ*) marks a heavy (emphatic) sound; *ḥ* and ɛ are throat sounds from Arabic.
- **ɣ** is a soft gargled 'gh'; **x** is a scratchy 'kh'; **c** says 'sh'; **ʷ** means rounded lips (*g*ʷ, *k*ʷ).
- **Doubled letters** (*tawwurt, ajjig*) are held a little longer. **e** is a tiny 'uh'.
- Words follow **Standard Moroccan Amazigh**; many of them are also used in Tashelhit, Central Atlas Tamazight or Tarifit.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Tamazight name** written in Tamazight (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The third box shows the **Latin letter** that IRCAM uses to write the same sound (ⵛ = c) and what kind of sound it is: a vowel, a consonant, a heavy (emphatic) consonant or a rounded-lips letter.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Standard Moroccan Amazigh (IRCAM).

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Tamazight! ⵜⴰⵎⴰⵣⵉⵖⵜ

tamaziɣt (tah-mah-zeeght) — the Tamazight word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **10 million people** in Morocco speak a Tamazight language at home: **Tashelhit**, **Central Atlas Tamazight** or **Tarifit**.[3]

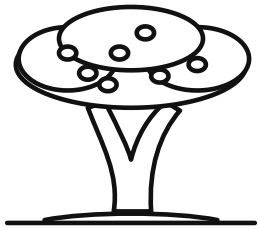
Where?
In Morocco's **Atlas** and **Rif** mountains, the **Sous** valley and cities such as Agadir, Marrakesh and Rabat. Cousin Amazigh languages are spoken across North Africa and the Sahara.

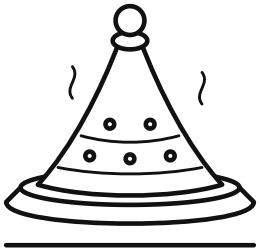
How is it written?
In **Tifinagh** letters, from **left to right**. Tamazight can also be written in Latin or Arabic letters.

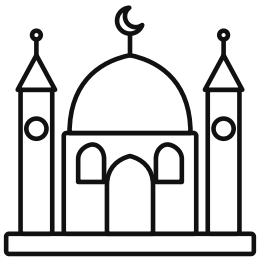
How many letters?
33 letters: 4 vowels, 2 half-vowels and 27 consonants, set out by IRCAM in 2003.

An official language
Since **2011**, Tamazight has been an official language of Morocco, alongside Arabic. Children learn Tifinagh at school, and street signs often show it.

Very old letters
Signs much like Tifinagh were carved on rocks in North Africa and the Sahara more than 2,000 years ago.







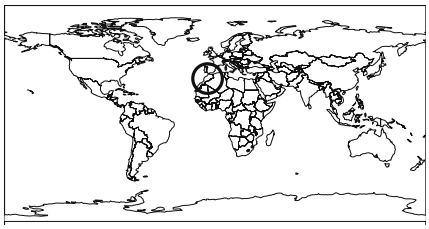
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Tamazight Alphabet ⵜⴰⵎⴰⵣⵉⵖ

33 letters — ⵜⴰⵎⴰⵣⵉⵖ

ⴰ *ya*	ⴱ *yab*	ⴳ *yag*	ⴳⵯ *yagʷ*	ⴷ *yad*	ⴹ *yaḍ*	ⴻ *yey*
ⴼ *yaf*	ⴽ *yak*	ⴽⵯ *yakʷ*	ⵀ *yah*	ⵃ *yaḥ*	ⵄ *yaɛ*	ⵅ *yax*
ⵇ *yaq*	ⵉ *yi*	ⵊ *yaj*	ⵍ *yal*	ⵎ *yam*	ⵏ *yan*	ⵓ *yu*
ⵔ *yar*	ⵕ *yaṛ*	ⵖ *yaɣ*	ⵙ *yas*	ⵚ *yaṣ*	ⵛ *yac*	ⵜ *yat*
ⵟ *yaṭ*	ⵡ *yaw*	ⵢ *yay*	ⵣ *yaz*	ⵥ *yaẓ*		

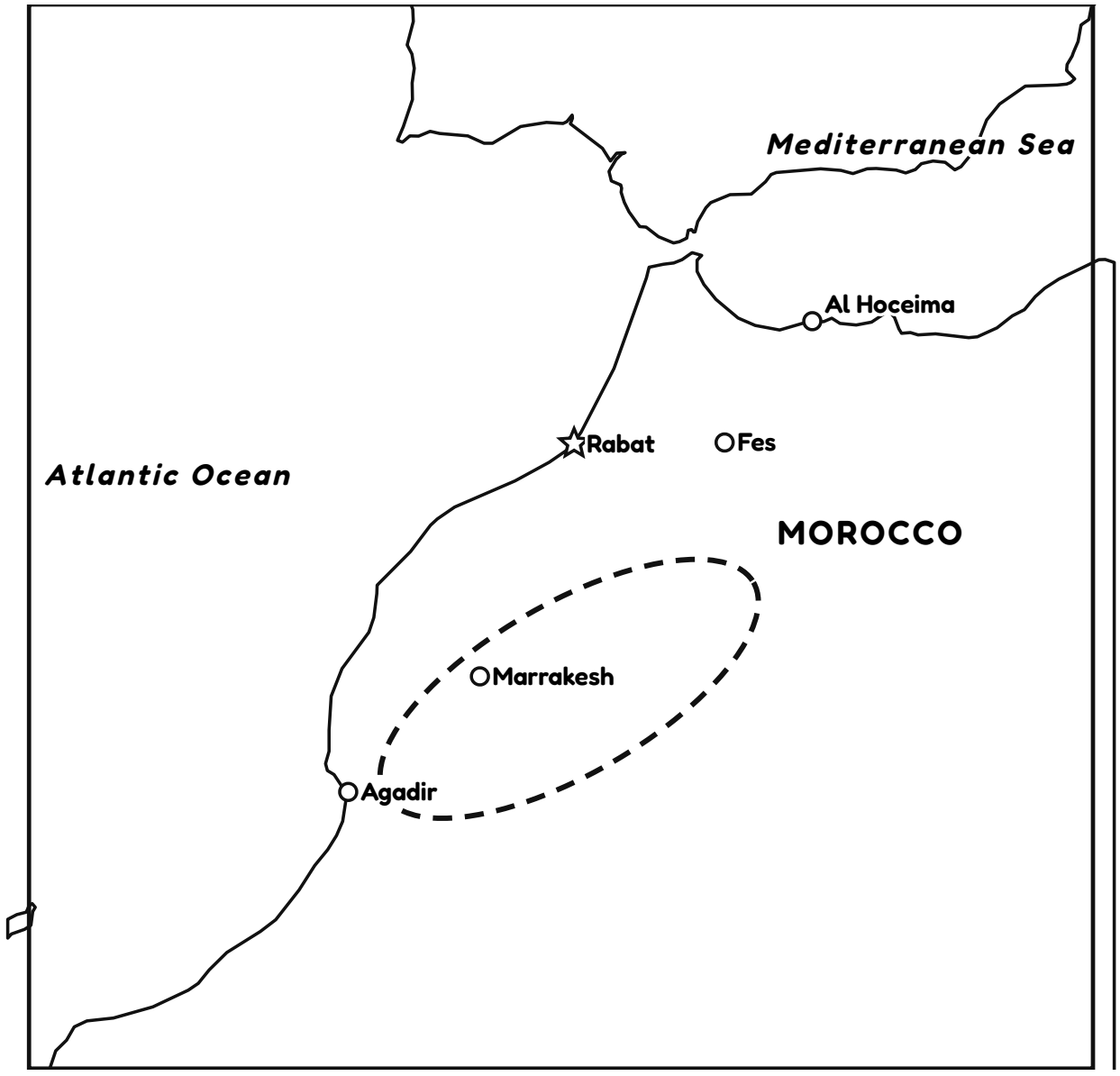
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Morocco on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Tamazight spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Rabat ★ is the capital. The dashed line goes round the Atlas mountains and the Sous valley, where many families speak Tamazight; Tarifit is spoken near Al Hoceima in the Rif.

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The Tifinagh Letters ⵜⴼⵉⵏⴰⵖ

tifinaɣ (tee-fee-naagh) — "the letters"

Tamazight is written in **Tifinagh**, from **left to right**, like English. Morocco's Royal Institute of Amazigh Culture (IRCAM) set out this alphabet of **33 letters** for schools.

Shapes you already know

Tifinagh letters are made of simple shapes: circles, lines, dots and crosses. ⵔ ⵣ ⵜ ⵙ ⵀ ⵄ — can you see the circle, the line, the cross?

Letters say "ya…"

The name of a consonant is **ya** + its sound: ⵢⴱ is *yab*, ⵢⵎ is *yam*. There are four vowels: ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ ⵎ (*a, i, u, e*).

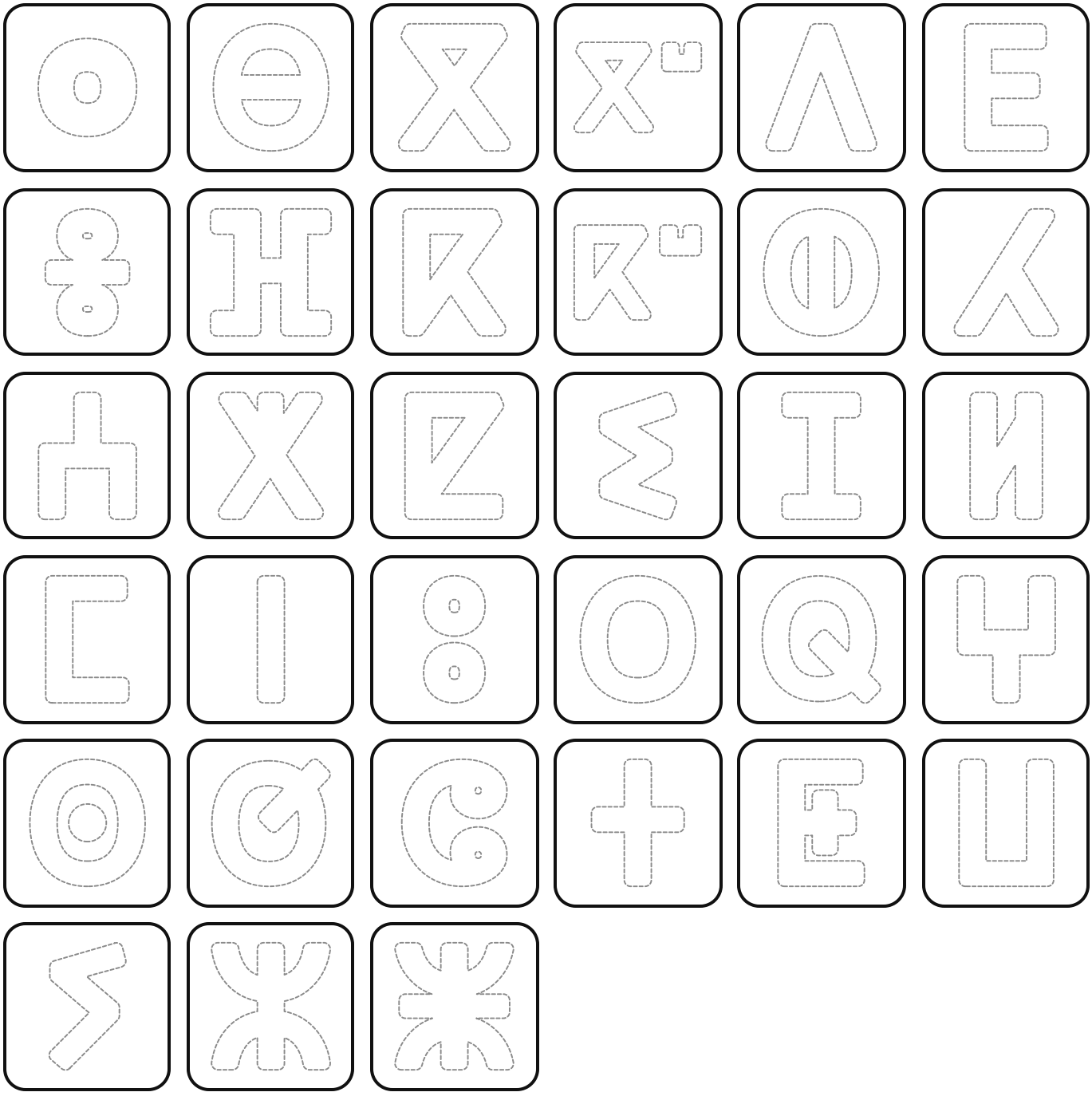
Heavy letters and round lips

Five letters are "heavy" (emphatic): ⵟ ⵇ ⵆ ⵒ ⵚ sound deeper than ⴷ ⵔ ⵜ ⴽ ⵙ. The little mark ⵯ means "round your lips": ⵅⵯ ⴽⵯ.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters ᑕᕮᕻᕮᓀᓱ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ⵄ

NAME · ⵉⵄⵎ · ISM

ⵢⵄ

ya

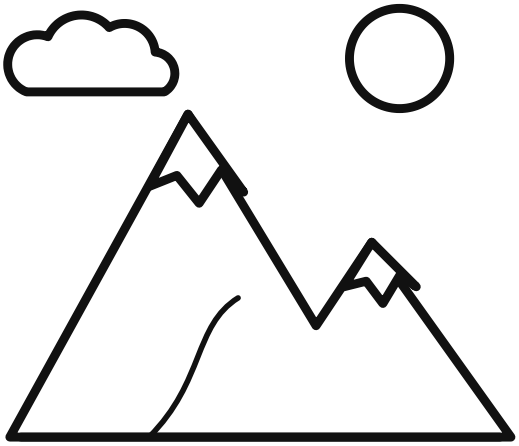
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵄ = a

a vowel



ⵄ IS FOR

ⵄⴰⵔⴰⵔ

adrar · *ah-drahr*

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⵄⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵄ ⵄ ⵄ ⵄ

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ⵉⴰⴱ

NAME · ⵉⵎⵔ · ISM

ⵉⴰⴱ

yab

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

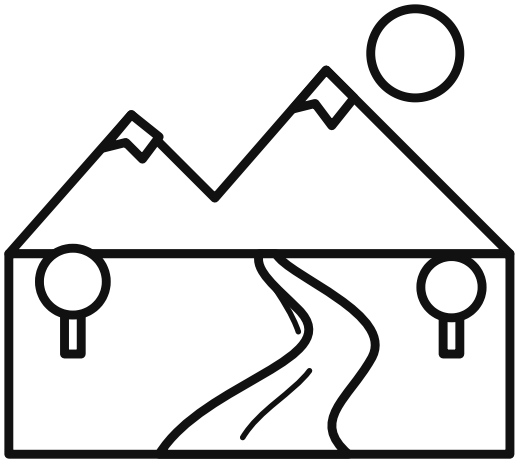
‘b’ as in “ball”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⴱ = b

a consonant

Find ⴱ inside ⴰⴱⵓⵉⵏ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⴱ IS FOR

ⴰⴱⵓⵉⵏ

abrid · *ah-breed*

road, path

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓⵔ · ARU

ⴱ ⴱ ⴱ ⴱ

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ⵅ

NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵅ

yag

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

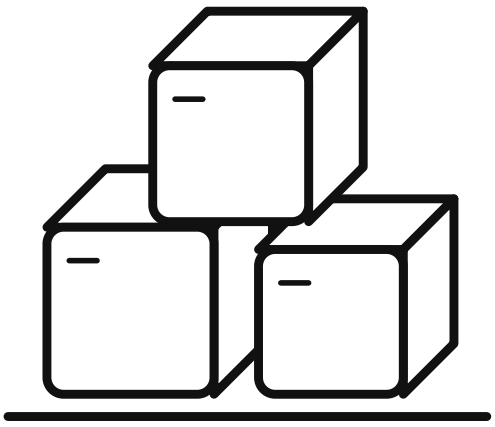
‘g’ as in “go”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵅ = g

a consonant

Find ⵅ inside ⴰⵅⵓⵉⵣⵓ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵅ IS FOR

ⴰⵅⵓⵉⵣⵓ

agris · *ah-grees*

ice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓⵔ · ARU

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ⵅⵯ

NAME · ⵉⵙⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵅⵯ

*yag*ʷ

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

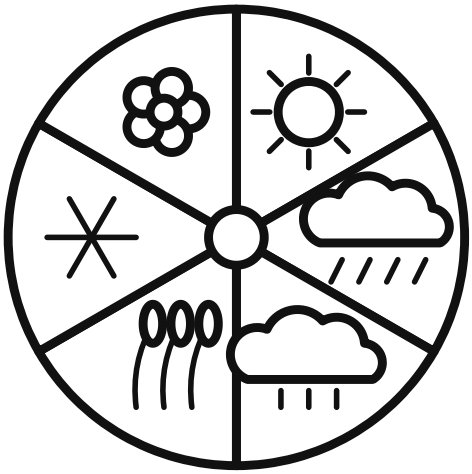
‘gw’ as in “Gwen”: a ‘g’ said with rounded lips

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵅⵯ = gʷ

a consonant with rounded lips: the little mark ⵯ means “round your lips”

Find ⵅⵯ inside ⴰⴱⵅⵅⵯⴰⴱ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵅⵯ **IS FOR**

ⴰⴱⵅⵅⵯⴰⴱ

asggʷas · *as-ggwahs*

year (and its seasons)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵅⵯ ⵅⵯ ⵅⵯ ⵅⵯ

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ⴷ

NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⴷ

yad

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⴷ = d

a consonant

Find ⴷ inside ⴰⴷⵍⵉⵙ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⴷ IS FOR

ⴰⴷⵍⵉⵙ

adlis · *ad-lees*

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓⵔ · ARU

ⴷ ⴷ ⴷ ⴷ

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Ḍ

NAME · ⵉⴰⴷ · ISM

ⵢⴰḌ

yaḍ

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

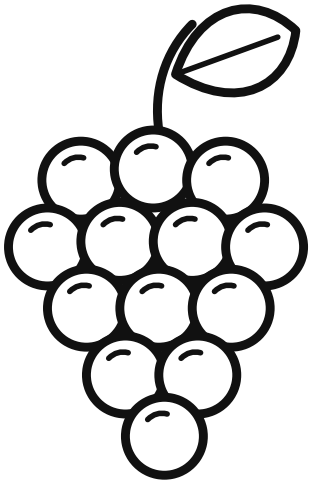
a heavy ‘d’ — a **heavy** (emphatic) sound: say it with the back of the tongue raised, so the vowels next to it sound deeper

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

Ḍ = ḍ

a heavy (emphatic) consonant

Find Ḍ inside ⴰḌⵉⵍ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



Ḍ **IS FOR**

ⴰḌⵉⵍ

aḍil · *ah-ḍeel*

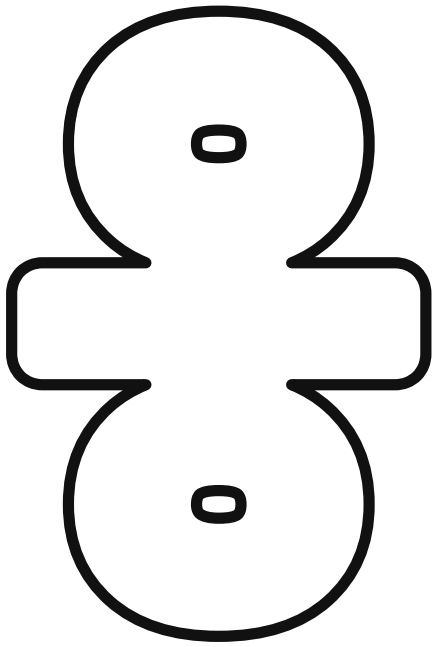
grapes

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

Ḍ Ḍ Ḍ Ḍ

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NAME · ⵉⵢⵢ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵢ

yey

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

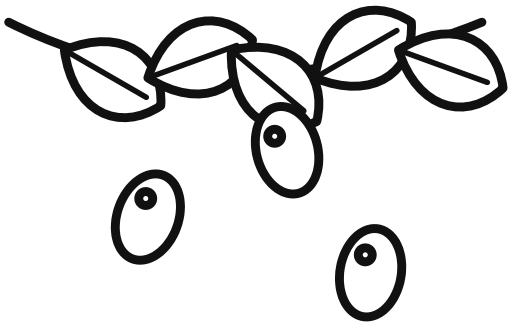
a tiny, quick ‘uh’ like the ‘a’ in “about”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⴻ = e

a very short vowel

ⴻ never starts a word. Find it in ⵄⵣⴻⵎⵎⵓⵔ! In standard spelling this short vowel is usually not written: ⵄⵣⵎⵎⵓⵔ.



ⴻ IS FOR

ⵄⵣⴻⵎⵎⵓⵔ

azemmur · *ah-zuh-moor*

olives

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⵄⵓⵔ · ARU

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ⵀ

NAME · ⵉⵙⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵀ

yaf

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

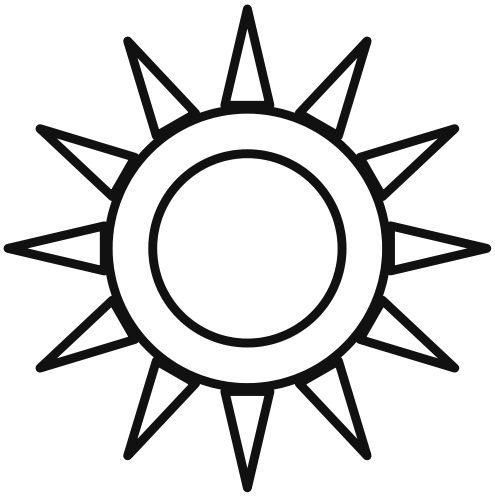
‘f’ as in “fan”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵀ = f

a consonant

Find ⵀ inside ⵜⴰⵀⵓⴽⵜ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵀ IS FOR

ⵜⴰⵀⵓⴽⵜ

tafukt · *tah-fookt*

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵀ ⵀ ⵀ ⵀ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ⵅ

NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵅ

yak

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

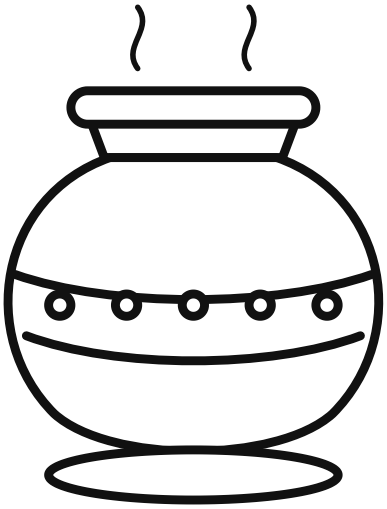
‘k’ as in “kite”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵅ = k

a consonant

Find ⵅ inside ⵜⵉⵅⵉⵏⵜ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵅ IS FOR

ⵜⵉⵅⵉⵏⵜ

tikint · *tee-keent*

cooking pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵅ ⵅ ⵅ ⵅ

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ⵅ

NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵅ

*yak*ʷ

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘kw’ as in “queen”: a ‘k’ said with rounded lips

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵅ = kʷ

a consonant with rounded lips: the little mark ◌ⵯ means “round your lips”

Find ⵅⵯ inside ⴰⵅⵯⵀⴰⵢ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵅⵯ **IS FOR**

ⴰⵅⵯⵀⴰⵢ

akʷfay · *akw-fai*

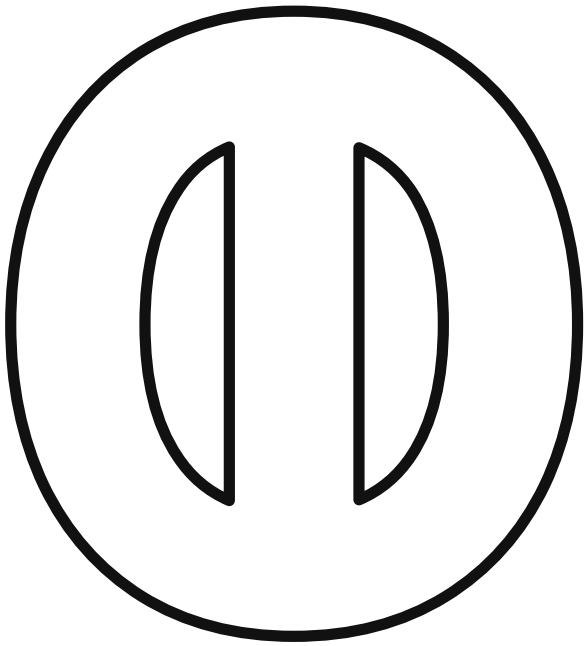
milk

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵅⵯ ⵅⵯ ⵅⵯ ⵅⵯ

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NAME · ⵢⴰⵀ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵀ

yah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵀ = h

a consonant

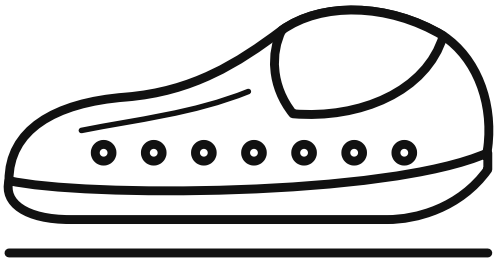
Find ⵀ inside ⴰⵀⴰⵔⴽⵓⵙ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.

ⵀ IS FOR

ⴰⵀⴰⵔⴽⵓⵙ

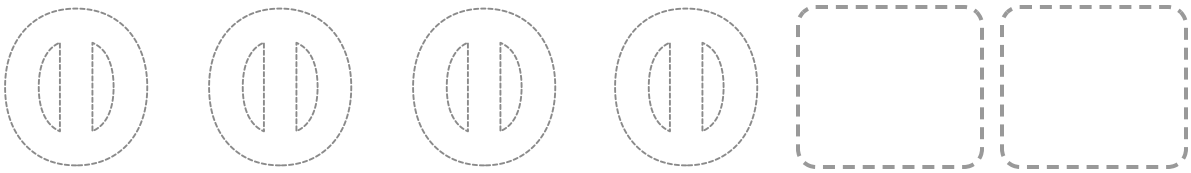
aharkus · *ah-har-koos*

slipper, sandal



Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓⵔ · ARU



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ⵀ

NAME · ⵉⵎⵙ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵀ

yaḥ

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a strong, breathy ‘h’ from the throat, like Arabic ح

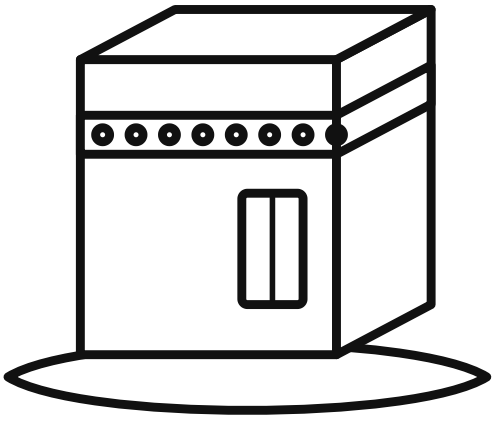
LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵀ = ḥ

a consonant

Used mostly in words from Arabic.

Find ⵀ inside ⵃⵀⵉⵊ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵀ **IS FOR**

ⵃⵀⵉⵊ

lḥijj · *l-ḥeejj*

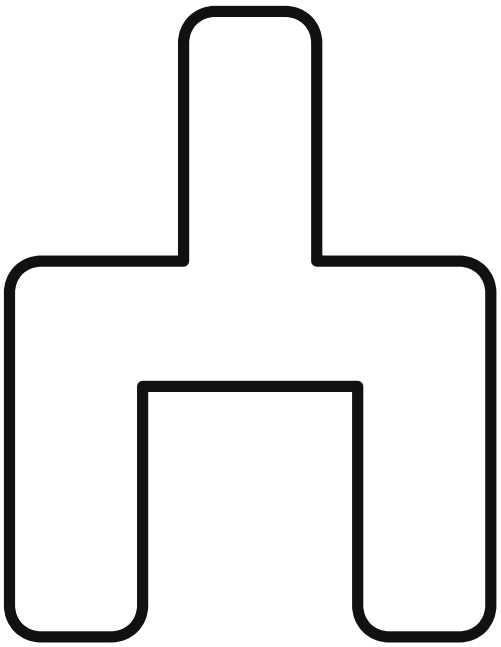
Hajj, the journey to the Kaaba in Makkah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵀ ⵀ ⵀ ⵀ

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NAME · ⵉⵄⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵄ

yaɛ

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a squeezed sound deep in the throat, like Arabic ع

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵄ = ɛ

a consonant

Used mostly in words from Arabic.

Find ⵄ inside ⵄⵉⴷⵍ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵄ IS FOR

ⵄⵉⴷⵍ

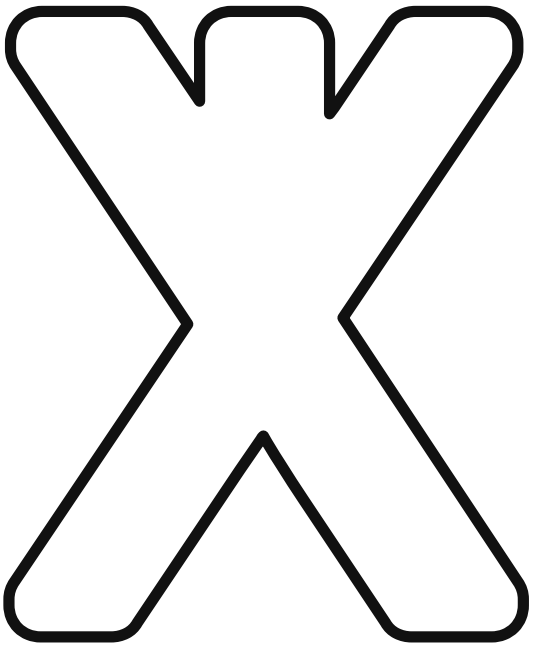
lɛid · *l-ɛeed*

Eid, the festival

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

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NAME · ⵉⵅⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵅ

yax

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

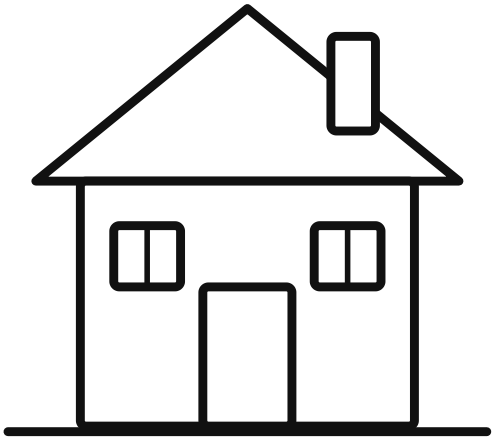
a scratchy ‘kh’ from the back of the throat, as in Scottish “loch”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

X = x

a consonant

Find ⵅ inside ⴰⵅⵅⴰⵎ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵅ **IS FOR**

ⴰⵅⵅⴰⵎ

axxam · *akh-khahm*

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵅ ⵅ ⵅ ⵅ

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ⵇ

NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵇ

yaq

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

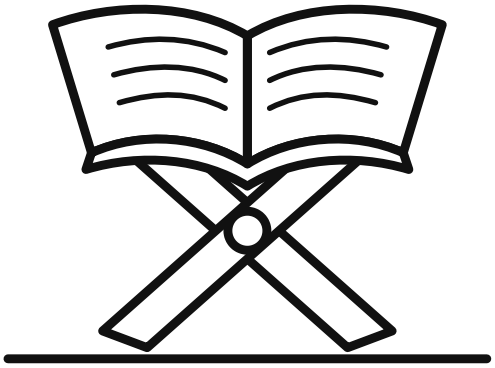
a ‘k’ said far back in the throat, like Arabic ق

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵇ = q

a consonant

Find ⵇ inside ⵑⵇⵓⵔⴰⵏ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵇ IS FOR

ⵑⵇⵓⵔⴰⵏ

Iqurɛan · *l-qur-ɛaan*

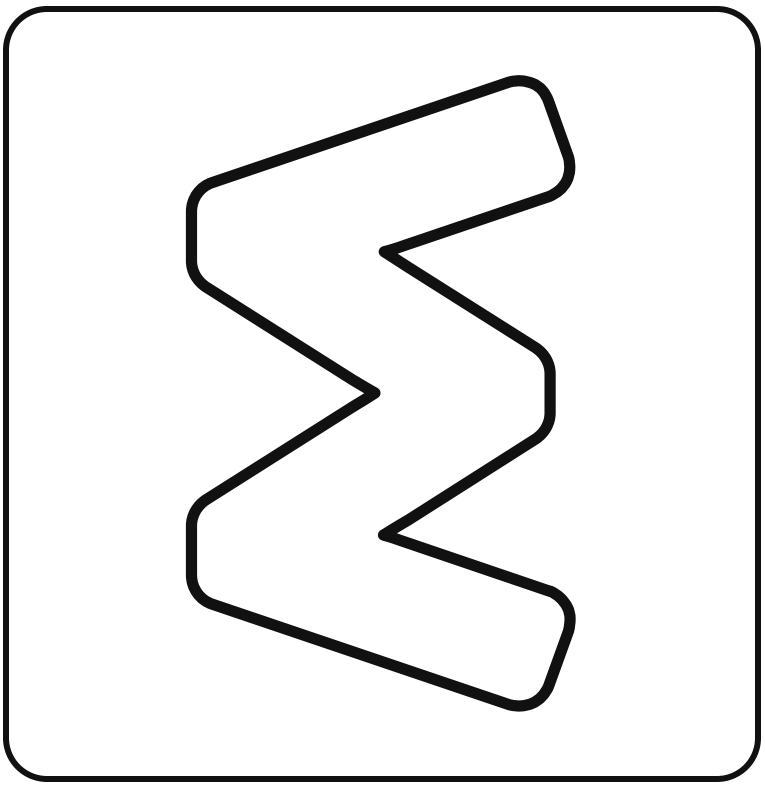
the Qur’an

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓⵔ · ARU

ⵇ ⵇ ⵇ ⵇ

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NAME · ⵉⵣⵔ · ISM

ⵢⵉ

yi

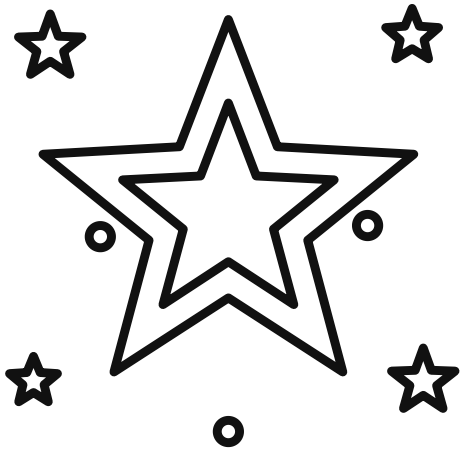
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵉ = i

a vowel



ⵉ IS FOR

ⵉⵜⵔⵉ

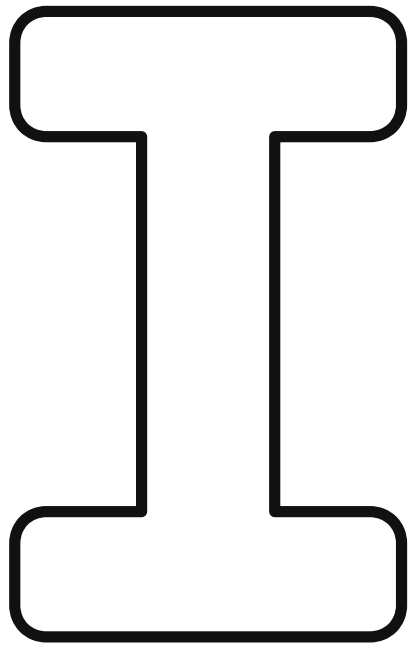
itri · *ee-tree*

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

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NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵉⵣI

yaj

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

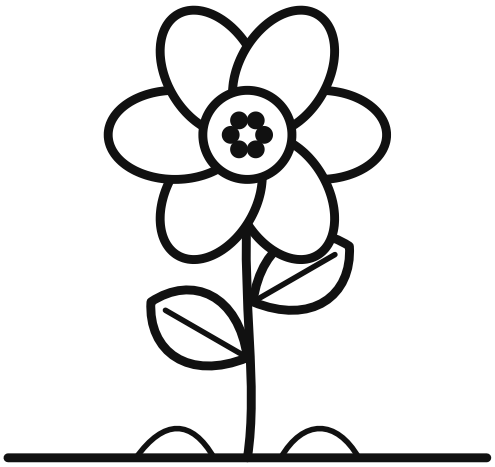
‘j’ as in “jam” (in some places ‘zh’, like the ‘s’ in “measure”)

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

I = j

a consonant

Find I inside ⴰIIⵉⵅ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



I **IS FOR**

ⴰIIⵉⵅ

ajjig · *aj-jeeg*

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓⵔ · ARU

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ⵍ

NAME · ⵉⵙⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵍ

yal

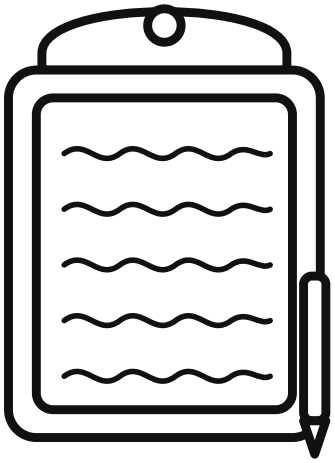
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵍ = l

a consonant



ⵍ IS FOR

ⵍⵍⵓⵖ

lluḥ · *l-looḥ*

wooden board for learning to write

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵍ ⵍ ⵍ ⵍ

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ⵎ

NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵎ

yam

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

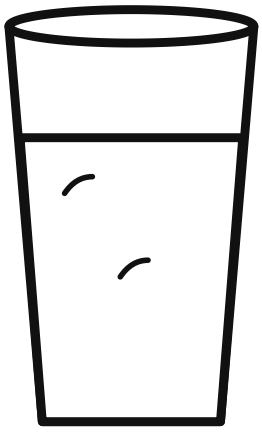
‘m’ as in “moon”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵎ = m

a consonant

Find ⵎ inside ⴰⵎⴰⵏ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵎ IS FOR

ⴰⵎⴰⵏ

aman · *ah-mahn*

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵎ ⵎ ⵎ ⵎ

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ⵏ

NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵏ

yan

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

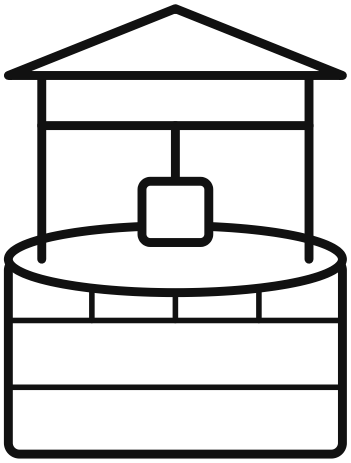
‘n’ as in “net”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵏ = n

a consonant

Find ⵏ inside ⴰⵏⵓ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵏ IS FOR

ⴰⵏⵓ

anu · *ah-noo*

well (for water)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓⵏ · ARU

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ⵓ ⵓ

NAME · ⵉⵙⵎ · ISM

ⵢⵓ

yu

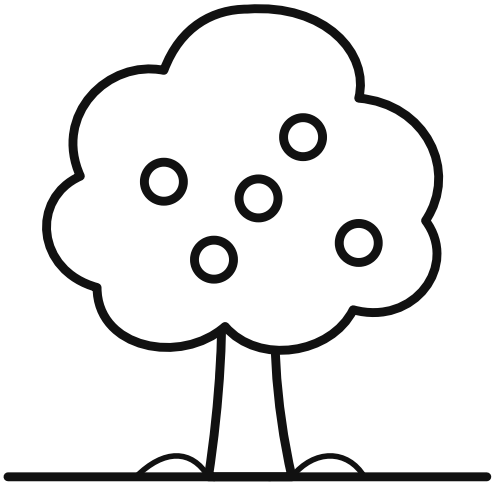
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵓ = **u**

a vowel



ⵓ IS FOR

ⵓⵔⵜⵉ

urti · *oor-tee*

garden, orchard

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓⵓ · ARU

ⵓ ⵓ ⵓ ⵓ

ⵓ ⵓ ⵓ ⵓ

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O

NAME · ⵉⵣⵔ · ISM

ⵢⴰO

yar

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

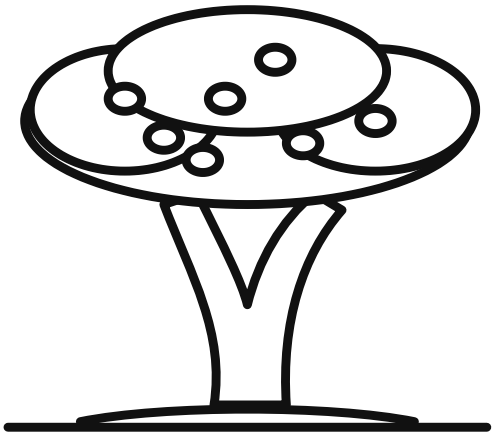
a tapped ‘r’ — flick the tongue once

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

O = r

a consonant

Find O inside ⴰOⵅⴰl! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵢ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



O **IS FOR**

ⴰOⵅⴰl

argan · *ar-gahn*

argan tree (it grows only in Morocco)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰOⵓ · ARU

O O O O

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Q

NAME · ⵉⵄⵔ · ISM

ⵢⵄQ

yaṛ

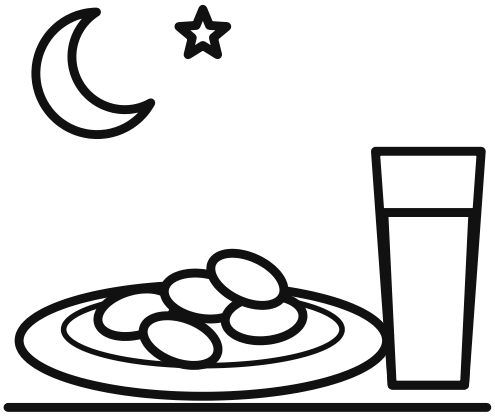
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a heavy ‘r’ — a **heavy** (emphatic) sound: say it with the back of the tongue raised, so the vowels next to it sound deeper

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

Q = ṛ

a heavy (emphatic) consonant



Q IS FOR

QⵔEⵄⵍ

ṛmḍan · *r-ma-ḍahn*

Ramadan, the month of fasting

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⵄⵓⵙ · ARU

Q Q Q Q

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ⵖ

NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵖ

yaɣ

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

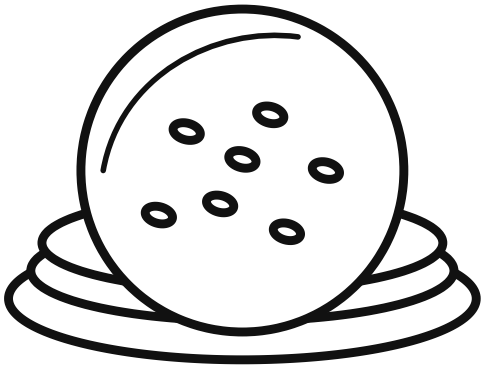
a soft gargled ‘gh’, like the French ‘r’ in “Paris”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵖ = ɣ

a consonant

Find ⵖ inside ⴰⵖⵓⵎ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵖ IS FOR

ⴰⵖⵓⵎ

aɣrum · *ah-ghroom*

bread

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓ · ARU

ⵖ ⵖ ⵖ ⵖ

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ⵙ

NAME · ⵙⵓⵎ · ISM

ⵙⴰⵙ

yas

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

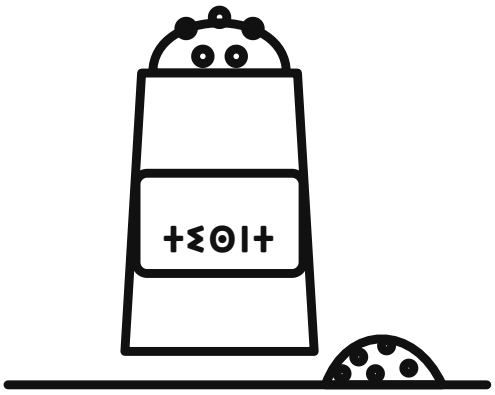
‘s’ as in “sun”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵙ = s

a consonant

Find ⵙ inside ⵜⵙⵓⵏⵜ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵙ IS FOR

ⵜⵙⵓⵏⵜ

tisnt · *tee-sunt*

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

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ⵟ

NAME · ⵉⵙⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵟ

yaṣ

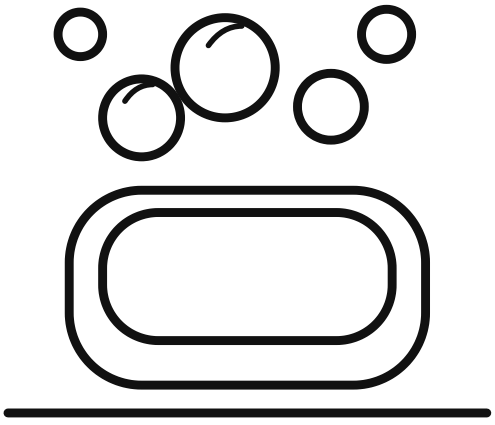
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a heavy ‘s’ — a **heavy** (emphatic) sound: say it with the back of the tongue raised, so the vowels next to it sound deeper

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ṭ = ṣ

a heavy (emphatic) consonant



ⵟ IS FOR

ⵟⵟⴰⴱⵓⵏ

ṣṣabun · *ṣ-ṣah-boon*

soap

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵓⵒ · ARU

ⵟ ⵟ ⵟ ⵟ

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ⵛ ⵛ

NAME · ⵉⵙⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵛ

yac

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

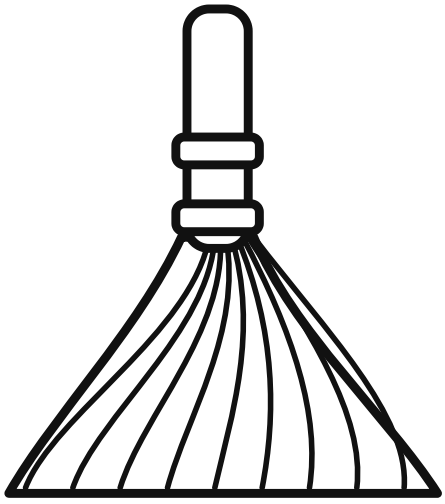
‘sh’ as in “shoe” (the Latin letter c always says ‘sh’)

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵛ = c

a consonant

Find ⵛ inside ⵜⴰⵛⵜⵜⴰⵜ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵛ IS FOR

ⵜⴰⵛⵜⵜⴰⵜ

tacṭṭabt · *tash-ṭṭahbt*

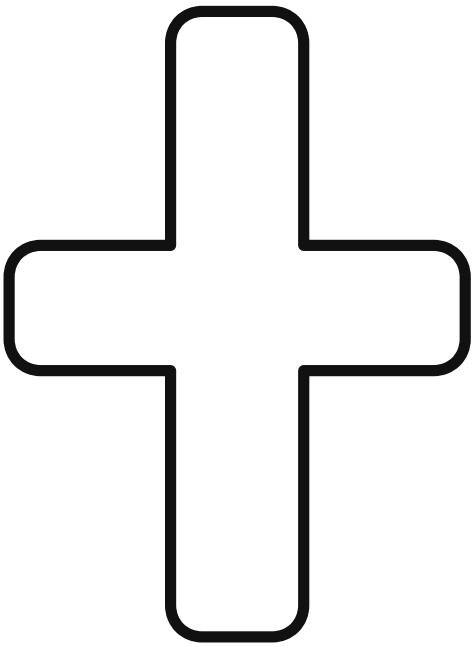
broom

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵕⵓ · ARU

ⵛ ⵛ ⵛ ⵛ

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NAME · ⵉⵟⵜ · ISM

ⵉⵟⵜ

yat

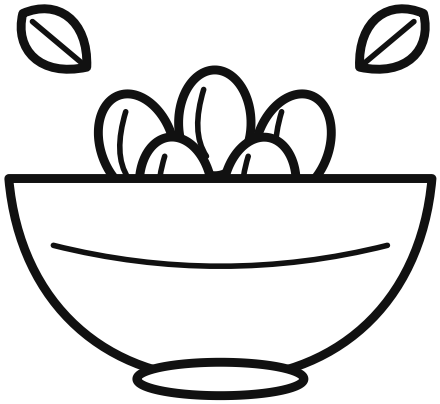
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵜ = t

a consonant



ⵜ IS FOR

ⵜⵉⵢⵏⵉ

tiyni · *teey-nee*

dates

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

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ⴹ

NAME · ⵉⵚⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⴹ

yaṭ

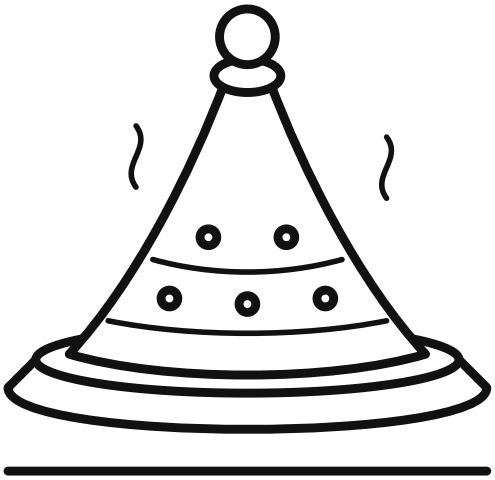
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a heavy ‘t’ — a **heavy** (emphatic) sound: say it with the back of the tongue raised, so the vowels next to it sound deeper

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⴹ = ṭ

a heavy (emphatic) consonant



ⴹ IS FOR

ⴹⴹⴰⵊⵉⵏ

ṭṭajin · *ṭ-ṭah-jeen*

tagine, a clay cooking pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⴹ ⴹ ⴹ ⴹ

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ⵡ

NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵢⴰⵡ

yaw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

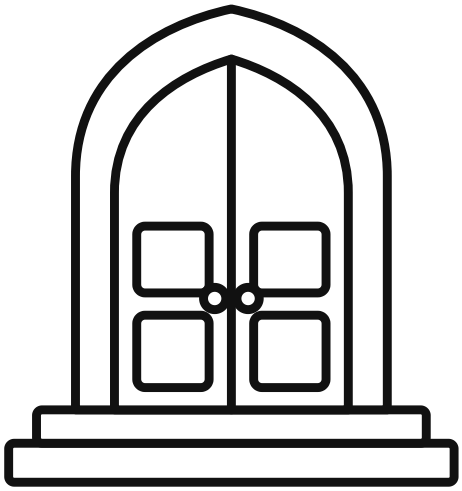
‘w’ as in “water”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵡ = w

a half-vowel

Find ⵡ inside ⵜⴰⵡⵡⵓⵔⵜ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵡ IS FOR

ⵜⴰⵡⵡⵓⵔⵜ

tawwurt · *taw-woort*

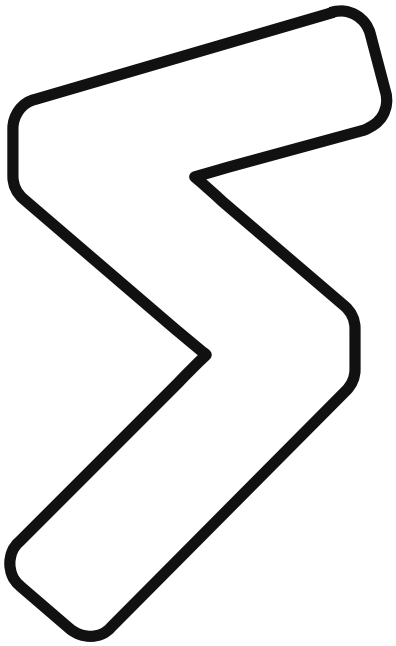
door

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵡ ⵡ ⵡ ⵡ

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NAME · ⵉⵢⵢ · ISM

ⵢⵢ

yay

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵢ = y

a half-vowel

Find ⵢ inside ⵄⵢⵢⵓⵄ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⵄ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵢ IS FOR

ⵄⵢⵢⵓⵄ

ayyur · *ay-yoor*

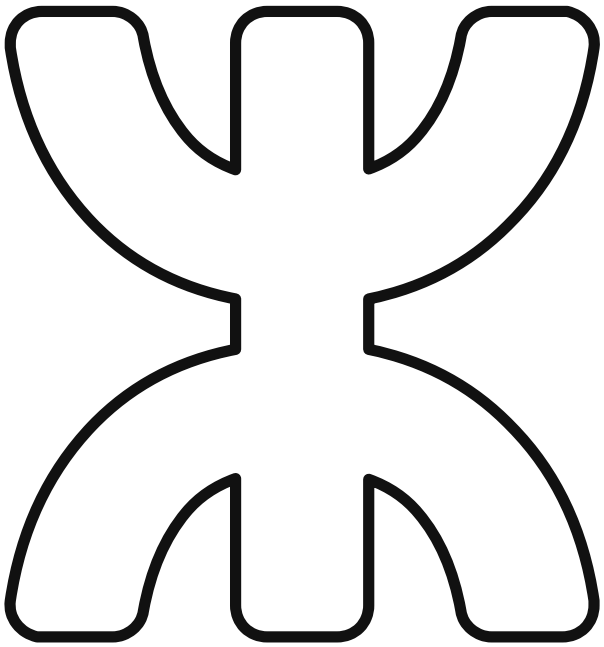
moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⵄⵓⵔ · ARU

ⵢ ⵢ ⵢ ⵢ

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NAME · ⵉⵣⵎ · ISM

ⵣⵓⵣ

yaz

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

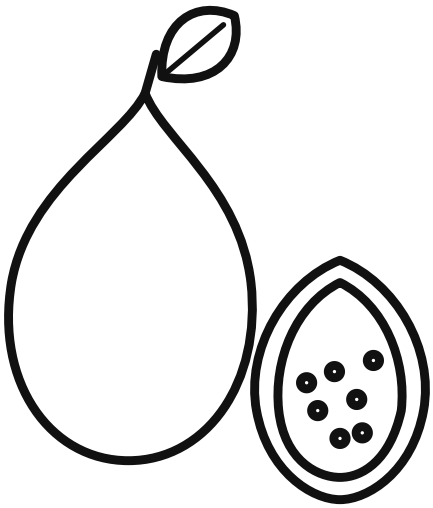
‘z’ as in “zoo”

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵣ = z

a consonant

Find ⵣ inside ⵜⵓⵣⵓⵔⵜ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⵓ ⵉ ⵏ) or with ⵜ.



ⵣ IS FOR

ⵜⵓⵣⵓⵔⵜ

tazart · *tah-zart*

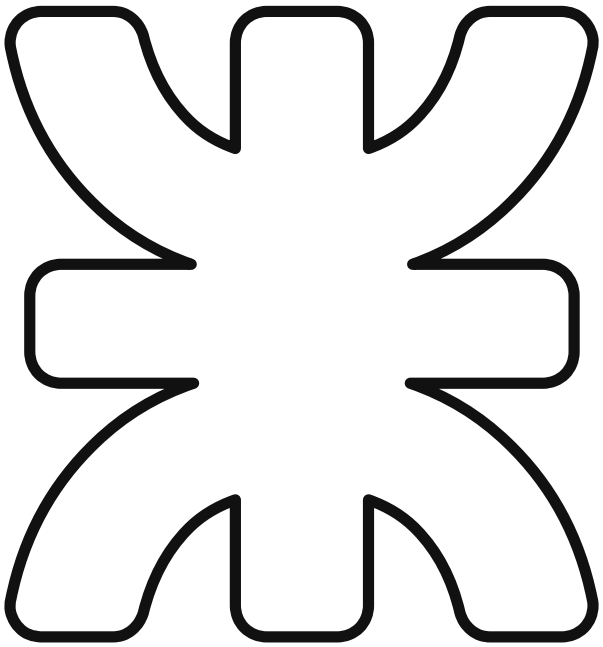
figs

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⵓⵔⵓ · ARU

ⵣ ⵣ ⵣ ⵣ

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NAME · ⵢⵣⵔ · ISM

ⵣⵕⵣ

yaẓ

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

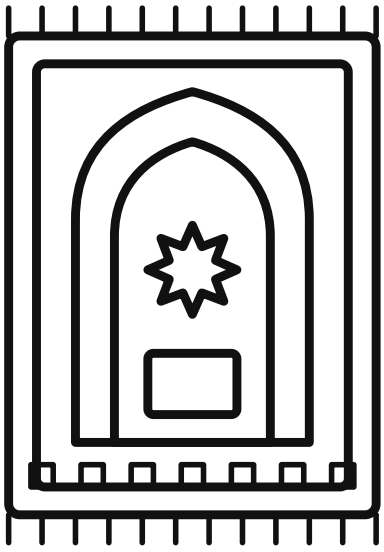
a heavy ‘z’ — a **heavy** (emphatic) sound: say it with the back of the tongue raised, so the vowels next to it sound deeper

LATIN LETTER · KIND OF SOUND

ⵣ = ẓ

a heavy (emphatic) consonant

Find ⵣ inside ⵜⴰⵣⴰⵍⵍⵉⵜ! Most Tamazight nouns begin with a vowel (ⴰ ⵉ ⵓ) or with ⵜ.



ⵣ IS FOR

ⵜⴰⵣⴰⵍⵍⵉⵜ

taẓallit · *tah-ẓal-leet*

prayer (salah)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

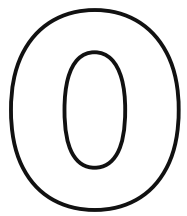
TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ⴰⵕⵓ · ARU

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BONUS

Tamazight numbers ⵉⵎⴷⴰⵏ *(imḍan)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Tamazight: *amya*, *yan*, *sin*, *kraḍ*...

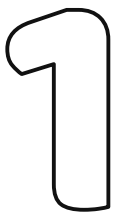


0

ⴰⵎⵢⴰ

amya

zero



1

ⵢⴰⵏ

yan

one



2

ⵙⵉⵏ

sin

two

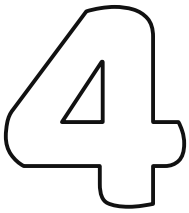


3

ⴽⵔⴰⴹ

kraḍ

three



4

ⴽⴽⵓⵥ

kkuẓ

four



5

ⵎⵎⵓⵙ

smmus

five



6

ⵙⴷⵉⵚ

sḍiṣ

six

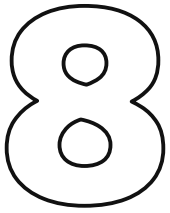


7

ⵙⴰ

sa

seven

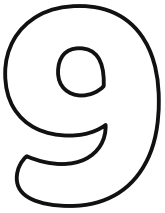


8

ⵜⴰⵎ

tam

eight



9

ⵜⵥⴰ

tẓa

nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Tamazight words ⵜⴰⵣⵔⵓⵜⵉⵏ ⵜⴰⵎⴰⵣⵉⵖⵜ

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

ⴰⵙⵙⴰⵍⴰⵎ ⵄⴰⵍⴰⵅⵓⵎ

as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAY-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

ⵡⴰⵄⴰⵍⴰⵅⵓⵎ ⴰⵙⵙⴰⵍⴰⵎ

wa-ah-LAY-koom as-sah-LAHM
And upon you be peace (the reply)

ⴰⵣⵓⵍ!

ah-ZOOL!
Hello!

ⵉⵙⵎ ⵉⵏⵓ ...

ism ee-NOO ...
My name is ...

ⵜⴰⵏⵎⵉⵔⵜ

tah-nuh-MEERT
Thank you

ⵊⴰⵣⴰⴽⴰⵍⵄⴰⵀⵓ ⵅⴰⵢⴰⵏ

jah-zah-KAH-lah-hoo KHAI-rahn
May Allah reward you with good

ⵢⵉⵎⵎⴰ · ⴱⴰⴱⴰ

YEEM-mah · BAH-bah
Mother · Father

ⴳ"ⵎⴰ · ⵓⵍⵜⵎⴰ

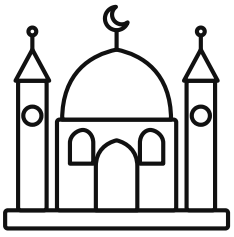
GWMAH · OOLT-mah
My brother · My sister

ⵢⴰⵀ · ⵓⵀ

yah · OO-hoo
Yes · No

ⴰⵔ ⵍⵎⵎⴷⵖ ⵜⴰⵎⴰⵣⵉⵖⵜ!

ar LMM-dugh tah-mah-ZEEGHT!
I am learning Tamazight!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

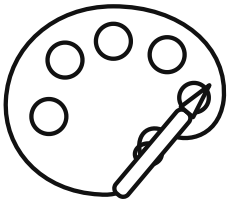
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International) and Morocco's 2014 census; the alphabet from **IRCAM** (Royal Institute of Amazigh Culture).

What's next?
You have met all **33 Tamazight letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Tamazight, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ⵎⴰⵛⴰⵀⴰⵍⵍⴰⵀ! ⵙⵙⵓⵖⵙ!

mah-shah-LAH! ee-FOOL-kee! — Mashallah! Well done — it is lovely!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 33 letters of the Tamazight alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author



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✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.